PRODUCT REQUIREMENTS DOCUMENT

Technology Capacity Intelligence Platform

A scenario planning and portfolio optimization tool for technology leadership

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Audience: Technology Leadership · Transformation Office

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01 · EXECUTIVE SUMMARY

Scripps Networks' technology organization is managing a portfolio of initiatives that exceeds the realistic capacity of its available leadership. The result is a pattern every leader in this organization recognizes: work in motion that is not moving, execution talent waiting for decisions that can't come fast enough, and commitments that slip not because people aren't working but because the organization lacks a clear view of what it can actually deliver.

The Technology Capacity Intelligence Platform (TCIP) is a decision-support application designed to give technology and transformation leadership a clear, data-driven answer to the question that currently goes unanswered: given our actual capacity, what is a realistic portfolio, and what are the cost and delivery implications of expanding or contracting it?

TCIP is not a project management system. It does not replace Jira, Wrike, or the McKinsey portfolio application. It is a scenario planning layer that sits above those systems — ingesting portfolio data, applying a capacity framework across teams, and producing actionable scenarios that leadership can use to make confident sequencing and resourcing decisions.

> *The core value proposition: TCIP transforms capacity planning from an annual budget conversation into a continuous, evidence-based leadership decision. It tells you not just what you have — but what you can do with it, what it costs, and what you give up when circumstances change.*

02 · PROBLEM STATEMENT

The Capacity Visibility Gap

Technology organizations at Scripps' scale routinely manage more initiatives than their leadership capacity can effectively drive. This is not a failure of ambition — it is a structural information problem. Without a shared, consistent view of who can drive work versus who executes within defined scope, and without mapping that capacity against a living portfolio of demand, the organization cannot answer basic planning questions with confidence.

What is not working today

- Each technology team tracks its capacity differently — by headcount, hours, story points, or informal knowledge. There is no common unit of measure.
- The portfolio of active and planned initiatives is not reconciled against available leadership capacity. Commitments are made without visibility into whether the leads exist to execute them.
- When capacity is discussed, the conversation defaults to total headcount rather than the distinction that matters: lead capacity (people who can own and drive work) versus support capacity (people who execute within defined scope).
- The cost implications of portfolio decisions — particularly the option to augment with offshore or contract support — are not modeled at the time decisions are made. They surface later, as budget variances.
- There is no mechanism for leadership to quickly model "what if" scenarios: what if we sequence out three initiatives, what if we add two offshore resources, what if a lead resource becomes unavailable?

The Business Consequence

The absence of this visibility produces compounding downstream effects. Initiatives stall not because teams are underperforming, but because the organization has over-committed its leadership capacity relative to the portfolio it is trying to run. Execution talent — internal and contracted — sits underutilized while waiting for direction from leads who are spread across too many workstreams to effectively drive any of them. The transformation agenda slows. Credibility with the executive team erodes.

> *The problem is not a shortage of people. It is a shortage of visibility — specifically, visibility into the ratio of lead capacity to portfolio demand, and what that ratio implies for sequencing, cost, and realistic execution timelines.*

03 · PROPOSED SOLUTION

TCIP is a web-based application with three integrated functional modules and a scenario output layer. Each module can be used independently, but the full value is realized when they operate together — ingesting team data, reconciling it against portfolio demand, and producing scenario outputs that leadership can act on.

Component	Function
Module 1	Team Roster & Capacity Classification — who is available and in what capacity
Module 2	Portfolio Ingestion & Reconciliation — what is being asked of the organization
Module 3	Resource Augmentation Planner — cost to expand or contract delivery through external resources
Output Layer	Portfolio Scenario Engine — what can be greenlit, what is sequenced, what it costs

04 · MODULE 1: TEAM ROSTER & CAPACITY CLASSIFICATION

Purpose

This module establishes the supply side of the capacity equation. Each technology team leader inputs their team's composition, classifying every resource as either Lead Capacity or Support Capacity — a distinction that reflects not seniority or title, but the ability to own and drive work end-to-end without requiring direction from another person.

Core Concepts

Term	Definition
Lead Capacity	A resource who can own an initiative or workstream end-to-end: setting direction, making decisions, resolving blockers, and being accountable for the outcome. Not defined by title. Defined by ownership capability. Measured in FTE equivalents.
Support Capacity	A resource who delivers skilled execution within defined scope — development, analysis, testing, documentation — but who requires direction and decision-making from a lead resource to be productive. Measured in FTE equivalents.
FTE Equivalent	The normalized unit of capacity across all resource types. A full-time employee = 1.0 FTE. A half-time contributor = 0.5 FTE. A contractor working 3 days per week = 0.6 FTE. This normalization allows meaningful comparison across teams with different resource structures.
Available FTE	FTE availability adjusted for standing obligations: BAU support, on-call rotation, team meetings, compliance training, and any known leave. Available FTE is what remains for project work.

Key Inputs

- Resource name or role title (name optional — role sufficient for anonymized planning)
- Classification: Lead or Support
- Total FTE (0.1 to 1.0)
- Estimated standing obligation percentage (BAU, support rotation, etc.)
- Computed available FTE for project delivery
- Resource type: internal employee, onshore contractor, offshore contractor
- Fully-loaded cost rate (annual or hourly) — used by the cost scenario module
- Notes: planned leave, part-time constraints, dual-role situations

Key Outputs

- Total lead FTE available per team
- Total support FTE available per team
- Cross-team lead FTE available (aggregated for portfolio reconciliation)

- Lead coverage ratio per team: lead FTE available divided by lead FTE demanded by current portfolio

Product Considerations

- Leaders should be able to update their roster at any time — not just during planning cycles. Roster changes should immediately recalculate coverage ratios and propagate to scenario outputs.
- The application should allow a leader to flag a resource as "tentative" — available but not yet confirmed — so that scenarios can show optimistic and conservative capacity ranges.
- The classification distinction (Lead vs. Support) should be clearly defined within the application via inline guidance. Not every organization will use these terms the same way. The definition must be anchored in the application itself, not assumed.
- The system should support a confidence rating on each resource's classification — allowing leaders to distinguish between resources they are certain are lead-capable versus those they are developing toward that capability.

05 · MODULE 2: PORTFOLIO INGESTION & RECONCILIATION

Purpose

This module establishes the demand side of the capacity equation. It ingests initiative and project data from Scripps' existing portfolio management application — currently a custom platform developed by McKinsey — and maps each initiative's capacity requirements against the supply data from Module 1. The result is a reconciled view of which initiatives can be fully resourced, which are constrained, and where lead coverage is the binding limitation.

Data Ingestion

TCIP will connect to the McKinsey portfolio application via API or structured data export. The ingestion mechanism should be configurable to accommodate changes in the source system over time. At minimum, the following data points are required for each initiative:

- Initiative name and unique identifier
- Initiative status (active, planned, on hold, proposed)
- Owning team and contributing teams
- Estimated lead FTE required (total and by quarter)
- Estimated support FTE required (total and by quarter)
- Target start and end dates
- Strategic priority tier (mapped to a configurable priority framework)
- Value score and readiness score — drawn from the existing value-generation model
- Dependencies on other initiatives

Reconciliation Logic

Once portfolio demand and team capacity are both loaded, TCIP performs a reconciliation across the full portfolio. This is the core analytical function of the application.

Calculation	Description
Lead Coverage Ratio	For each team and for the organization in aggregate: total available lead FTE divided by total lead FTE demanded by the current active portfolio. Ratios below 0.8 are flagged as critical. 0.8 to 1.0 as constrained. Above 1.0 as sufficient.
Initiative Feasibility Status	Each initiative is evaluated against available lead and support capacity and assigned a feasibility status: Greenlit (capacity exists), Sequenced (capacity available in a future period), Constrained (lead bottleneck), or Deferred (insufficient capacity under current assumptions).
Lead Bottleneck Flag	Any initiative where lead capacity is the binding constraint — not support capacity, budget, or dependencies — is flagged explicitly. This surfaces the structural problem without burying it in aggregate numbers.

Calculation	Description
Portfolio Carrying Capacity	The maximum number of initiatives the organization can actively drive given current lead capacity. Calculated as: total available lead FTE divided by average lead FTE tax per initiative (configurable, defaulting to 0.25 FTE per active initiative per quarter).
Dependency Mapping	Initiatives with upstream dependencies are evaluated in sequence — a downstream initiative cannot be greenlit until its upstream dependency is on track or complete.

Product Considerations

- The application should allow leaders to manually override the system's feasibility assessment on any initiative — with a required notation explaining the override. This preserves leadership judgment while maintaining auditability.
- Once portfolio scenarios are finalized, TCIP should support export in formats compatible with Jira, Wrike, and similar execution management systems. The intent is that decisions made in TCIP flow downstream into the tools where work is managed, without requiring re-entry.
- The system should surface initiatives where value score and readiness score are both high but feasibility is constrained — these are the highest-priority candidates for lead capacity investment or portfolio sequencing decisions.
- Historical reconciliation snapshots should be retained so that leadership can see how the coverage ratio and portfolio feasibility have evolved over time.

06 · MODULE 3: RESOURCE AUGMENTATION PLANNER

Purpose

This module addresses a question that current planning processes answer too slowly and too late: what does it cost to expand or contract delivery capacity, and what does that investment unlock in the portfolio? It is a staffing optimization and scenario planning tool that models the cost and portfolio implications of augmenting internal capacity with onshore contractors, offshore resources, or targeted external hires.

Resource Augmentation Dimensions

Augmentation Type	Description
Internal Lead Development	Model the impact of identifying internal support-classified resources who have lead potential and investing in their development. This is a lower-cost path to increasing lead coverage that is frequently overlooked in favor of external hiring.
Onshore Contractor Augmentation	Model the cost and capacity impact of adding onshore contract resources in either lead or support roles. Configurable by role type, bill rate, and engagement duration.
Offshore Resource Augmentation	Model the cost and capacity impact of adding offshore resources in support roles. Offshore resources are typically best applied to well-defined execution work within active initiatives rather than to lead functions. Configurable by region, bill rate, time zone overlap factor, and productivity adjustment.
Blended Team Modeling	Model combinations of the above — for example, one onshore lead plus four offshore support resources on a specific initiative — and see the cost and portfolio impact of the full blended team.

Cost Modeling Inputs

- Internal FTE fully-loaded cost rate (salary + benefits + overhead) — entered per resource or estimated by role band
- Onshore contractor bill rates by role type and seniority
- Offshore contractor bill rates by region and role type
- Productivity adjustment factor for offshore resources (configurable — accounts for ramp time, time zone overlap, and coordination overhead)
- Engagement duration by resource (project-length, quarterly, or annual)
- Internal coordination overhead per offshore resource (fraction of onshore lead time consumed by managing offshore execution)

Key Outputs

- Total cost of the current portfolio under base-case staffing assumptions
- Marginal cost of each additional resource added to the model
- Cost per initiative under different staffing configurations

- Portfolio initiatives unlocked per dollar of augmentation investment
- Break-even analysis: at what staffing level does the cost of augmentation equal the estimated value of the initiatives it unlocks

Product Considerations

- The offshore module should model not just cost but effective capacity — accounting for coordination overhead consumed by onshore leads in managing offshore resources. Adding offshore support at scale without modeling the lead tax it creates can produce the counterintuitive outcome of reducing total throughput while increasing cost.
- The application should allow leaders to set a cost ceiling for a given planning period and optimize for maximum portfolio delivery within that ceiling — a constrained optimization function rather than a pure scenario display.
- Rate assumptions should be editable without developer involvement — a configuration layer accessible to authorized administrators allows the model to stay current as market rates change.

07 · OUTPUT LAYER: PORTFOLIO SCENARIO ENGINE

Purpose

The scenario engine is the primary leadership-facing surface of TCIP. It synthesizes the outputs of all three modules into a set of named, comparable scenarios that answer the questions technology and transformation leadership need to answer: what can we actually execute, what will it cost, and what are the trade-offs?

Standard Scenario Types

Scenario	Description
Base Case	Current internal staffing, current portfolio. Shows what is greenlit, what is sequenced, what is deferred, and the lead coverage ratio. This is the honest answer to "what can we execute right now."
Portfolio Trim	Remove lowest-value or lowest-readiness initiatives from the active portfolio. Shows how coverage ratio improves, which remaining initiatives benefit from reduced lead tax, and what is deprioritized.
Augmented — Onshore	Add a specified number of onshore lead or support resources. Shows additional initiatives unlocked, revised coverage ratio, and incremental cost.
Augmented — Offshore Blend	Add offshore support resources to active initiatives, modeled with coordination overhead. Shows cost reduction potential versus onshore-only staffing, effective capacity gained, and net throughput change.
Hybrid Optimization	Combination of portfolio trim and targeted augmentation. Models the most cost-effective path to executing a defined set of priority initiatives.
Stress Test	Remove a specified number of lead resources — simulating attrition, leave, or reallocation — and show the portfolio impact. Useful for risk planning and succession conversations.

Scenario Output Format

Each scenario should produce a consistent set of outputs that can be reviewed in-application and exported for leadership presentations:

- Portfolio summary: total initiatives greenlit, sequenced, and deferred
- Lead coverage ratio (current and projected)
- Total portfolio cost under this scenario
- Initiatives unlocked relative to base case
- Named initiatives in each status category, with value score and readiness score visible
- Timeline view: which initiatives can start in which quarter given sequenced capacity
- Export: PDF summary, Excel data extract, and structured data export for downstream planning tools

Product Considerations — Scenario Engine

- Scenarios should be saveable and named by the user — leadership will want to return to a scenario they built in a prior session, share it with a colleague, or compare two named scenarios side by side.
- A side-by-side scenario comparison view is essential. The ability to see Base Case versus Augmented side by side — with delta indicators showing what changed — is what makes the tool useful in a leadership meeting rather than just in preparation for one.
- The scenario engine should include a "recommendation engine" that surfaces the highest-value, highest-readiness initiatives that are currently deferred and shows the minimum augmentation required to greenlight each one. This turns the tool from a passive display into an active advisor.

08 · ADDITIONAL CAPABILITIES & PRODUCT CONSIDERATIONS

Capabilities a Full Product Should Include

The following capabilities are not part of the initial module definitions but represent the difference between a functional tool and a platform that compounds value over time. They should be considered in the design and architecture of the initial build to avoid costly retrofitting.

Trend and Historical Tracking

- Record coverage ratio snapshots over time so that leadership can see whether the capacity situation is improving or deteriorating relative to the portfolio.
- Track how often overrides are applied to the system's feasibility assessments — a high override rate is a signal that either the model inputs need improvement or that organizational forces are overriding analytical signals.
- Visualize portfolio velocity: are initiatives moving from Sequenced to Greenlit at a rate that suggests improving capacity, or are they aging in the queue?

Notifications and Triggers

- Alert technology leaders when their team's lead coverage ratio drops below a configurable threshold — proactive notification rather than periodic review.
- Flag initiatives that have been in "Sequenced" status for more than a configurable number of weeks, prompting a reassessment of whether they should be deferred, reprioritized, or resourced differently.
- Trigger a reconciliation whenever the portfolio ingestion feed updates — ensuring the scenario outputs always reflect the current portfolio state.

Role-Based Access and Views

- Team leaders see their own roster and their team's contribution to the portfolio.
- Technology leadership peers see aggregated capacity across all teams without individual resource detail.
- The transformation office and CTO see full portfolio scenarios, cost outputs, and recommendation engine outputs.
- Roster data — particularly cost rates and individual names — should be accessible only to authorized roles.

Integration Architecture

- API connection to the McKinsey portfolio application for initiative ingestion — with a configurable field mapping layer that insulates TCIP from upstream schema changes.
- Export adapters for Jira and Wrike — allowing a finalized scenario to generate a project structure in the execution tool, not just a report.
- HRIS integration (optional, Phase 2) — to pull FTE availability and cost data directly rather than requiring manual entry. Reduces administrative burden and improves accuracy.
- SSO integration with Scripps identity provider for access management.

Data Quality and Governance

- The system is only as useful as its inputs. Build in data quality indicators that surface when roster data is stale (last updated more than 30 days ago), when initiative FTE estimates appear implausible relative to historical actuals, or when coverage ratios have not been reviewed in a defined period.
- Maintain a full audit log of scenario changes, roster updates, and override decisions. Leadership credibility depends on the ability to explain how conclusions were reached.

09 · SUCCESS METRICS

TCIP succeeds if it changes the quality of portfolio and capacity decisions made by technology leadership — not if it is technically complete. The following metrics define success:

Metric	Definition	Measurement
Adoption	100% of technology team leaders maintain a current roster in TCIP within 60 days of launch	Active roster with last-updated date within 30 days
Decision Quality	Portfolio sequencing decisions are made with explicit reference to lead coverage ratio, not intuition or political negotiation	Coverage ratio cited in portfolio decision documentation
Scenario Utilization	Technology leadership runs at least one scenario per planning cycle; transformation office uses TCIP outputs in budget conversations	Scenario export activity per planning cycle
Cost Modeling Adoption	Resource augmentation decisions reference TCIP cost scenarios before headcount or contract requests are submitted	Reduction in unmodeled resource requests
Portfolio Health	Lead coverage ratio improves quarter-over-quarter as sequencing and augmentation decisions take effect	Aggregate lead coverage ratio by quarter
Execution Velocity	Initiatives in "Greenlit" status ship at a higher rate than pre-TCIP baseline, reflecting better capacity alignment at commitment time	Greenlit initiative completion rate versus historical baseline

10 · SUGGESTED PHASING

TCIP should be built in phases that deliver immediate value while preserving the architecture for full platform capability. The phasing below is illustrative — specific timelines should be determined in collaboration with the development team.

Phase	Scope and Goal
Phase 1 (Months 1–3)	Core roster management (Module 1), manual portfolio entry (Module 2 without API ingestion), basic scenario engine showing greenlit / sequenced / deferred status. Goal: replace the spreadsheet-based process with a live, shared tool that technology leadership uses in the working session.
Phase 2 (Months 3–6)	Portfolio API ingestion from McKinsey application, lead bottleneck flagging, resource augmentation cost modeling (Module 3), side-by-side scenario comparison. Goal: make the tool useful for ongoing leadership and budget conversations, not just periodic planning sessions.
Phase 3 (Months 6–12)	Recommendation engine, trend and historical tracking, Jira / Wrike export adapters, role-based access controls, notification and trigger system. Goal: move from a decision-support tool to a platform that proactively surfaces capacity risks and opportunities.
Phase 4 (12+ months)	HRIS integration, advanced optimization (constrained cost ceiling planning), portfolio velocity metrics, executive dashboard for transformation office. Goal: full platform maturity; TCIP becomes a permanent fixture in technology planning infrastructure.

11 · OPEN QUESTIONS FOR DEVELOPMENT PARTNERSHIP

The following questions should be resolved in collaboration with the development team during scoping. They are open by design — they represent decisions that benefit from technical input before being finalized.

1. What is the most reliable and maintainable integration approach for the McKinsey portfolio application — real-time API, scheduled export, or a hybrid? What does the McKinsey application's data model look like, and how closely does it map to the fields TCIP requires?
2. What is the preferred deployment architecture — cloud-hosted SaaS, Scripps-hosted on existing Azure infrastructure, or a hybrid? What are the data residency and security requirements that constrain this choice?
3. How should the system handle the scenario where a resource is shared across multiple teams? The current model assumes team-level rosters, but in practice some lead resources are matrixed across functions.
4. What is the right granularity for cost modeling — annual fully-loaded rates, hourly bill rates, or project-level budget envelopes? This has significant implications for the complexity of Module 3 and the accuracy of the portfolio cost outputs.
5. Should the recommendation engine optimize purely on value score and readiness, or should it incorporate strategic priority tiers that reflect organizational imperatives independent of project-level scoring?
6. What level of data sensitivity applies to individual cost rates and roster information? This determines the access control architecture and whether the tool can be used openly in leadership meetings or requires a restricted view for certain audiences.

APPENDIX · GLOSSARY OF TERMS

Term	Definition
Available FTE	FTE availability adjusted for standing obligations (BAU, on-call, meetings). Represents capacity available for project delivery.
Base Case	The scenario reflecting current internal staffing against the current active portfolio. The honest starting point for all planning.
FTE Equivalent	Normalized unit of capacity. 1.0 = full-time. Used across all resource types for consistent comparison.
Greenlit	An initiative with confirmed lead and support capacity available to begin or continue in the current planning period.
Lead Capacity	Resources capable of owning and driving work end-to-end without requiring direction. Defined by ownership capability, not seniority.
Lead Coverage Ratio	Available lead FTE divided by lead FTE demanded by the active portfolio. The primary diagnostic metric in TCIP.
Lead Tax	The recurring demand on lead capacity generated by each active initiative, regardless of delivery status. Estimated at 0.25 FTE per initiative per quarter as a default.
Portfolio Carrying Capacity	Maximum initiatives the organization can actively drive given current lead FTE. Total available lead FTE divided by average lead tax per initiative.
Sequenced	An initiative that cannot begin in the current period due to lead capacity constraints, but is planned for a future period when capacity will be available.
Support Capacity	Resources who execute skilled work within defined scope. Productive when led; blocked when lead capacity is the constraint.
TCIP	Technology Capacity Intelligence Platform. The application described in this document.

END OF DOCUMENT

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